

## **2. MEANING AND NATURE OF EDUCATIONAL OBJECTIVES**

The educational objectives are expressions of what a teacher hopes his/ her students can accomplish as a result of his / her teaching. Educational objectives are policy statements of direction and provides foundation of the entire educational structure. These are the statements which express specifically and in measurable terms, an attitude that will be developed cognitive or psychomotor skills that the students would be able to do as a result of prescribed treatment method or mode of instruction.

There are following types of educational objectives

- Institutional
- Departmental / intermediate
- Specific instructional/ behavioral objectives

### **Institutional/ general objectives**

A set of statements identifying the major skills that all the graduates of the program should possess at the completion of their studies.

### **Departmental/ intermediate**

A set of statements identifying the skills to be acquired by all students who are taught within a particular institution. These skills must be consistent with the institutional objectives.

### **Specific/ Instructional objectives**

Basic instructional objectives (BIO): A brief, clear statement of basic skill/ competence which is to be demonstrated at the conclusion of a unit instruction.

Specific instructional objectives (SIO): A brief, clear statement of a single skill, directly related to BIO and stated in terms of observable student behavior.

### **Elements of Specific Objectives**

1. **Activity:** appropriate action verb to be used
2. **Content:** what is to be implemented or performed
3. **Condition:** with or without help of equipment, books, specimens reports etc.
4. **Criteria:** Minimum level of performance

### **Taxonomy of objectives**

A taxonomy is a hierarchical classification in a given field. It provides a classification of various instructional objectives at suitable levels and in given spheres.

A systematic organization of objectives into three domains to help the teachers in precise formulation and evaluates the result of a system of education, helps students to prepare for examinations to obtain the desired end results.

There are three types of objectives:

- Cognitive
- Affective
- Psychomotor

### **Cognitive Objectives**

Cognitive objectives are designed to increase an individual's knowledge. Cognitive objectives relate to understandings, awareness, insights (e.g., "Given a description of a planet, the student will be able to identify that planet, as demonstrated verbally or in writing, with 100% accuracy." or "The student will be able to evaluate two different theories of the origin of the solar system as demonstrated by his/her ability to compare and discuss verbally or in writing the strengths and weaknesses of each theory."). This includes knowledge or information recall, comprehension or conceptual understanding, the ability to apply knowledge, the ability to analyze a situation, the ability to synthesize information from a given situation, the ability to evaluate a given situation, and the ability to create something new.

### **Affective Objectives**

Affective objectives are designed to change an individual's attitude. Affective objectives refer to attitudes, appreciations, and relationships (e.g., "Given the opportunity to work in a team with several people of different races, the student will demonstrate an positive increase in attitude towards non-discrimination of race, as measured by a checklist utilized/completed by non-team members.").

### **Psychomotor Objectives**

Psychomotor objectives are designed to build a physical skill (e.g., "The student will be able to ride a two-wheel bicycle on a flat road surface without assistance and without pause for 10 seconds without falling as demonstrated in gym class."); actions that demonstrate the fine motor skills such as use of precision instruments or tools, or actions that evidence gross motor skills such as the use of the body in dance or athletic performance.